

Written

SELECT (DISTINCT)	5
FROM and JOIN	1
WHERE	2
GROUP BY	3
HAVING	4
ORDER BY	6
LIMIT	7

Evaluated, logically

1	FROM and JOIN	assemble the rows of the tables and their joins
2	WHERE	keep the rows that meet the condition
3	GROUP BY	form the groups
4	HAVING	keep the groups that meet the condition
5	SELECT and DISTINCT	calculate the columns and aliases, then drop duplicate rows
6	ORDER BY	sort the result; the aliases of SELECT can be used
7	LIMIT	keep the first rows

The number beside each written clause is the step at which it is evaluated. WHERE runs before any group exists, so it cannot use an aggregate; HAVING runs after grouping, and ORDER BY after SELECT.